# Playing-Card Key

Play with one regular deck of cards, jokers included. Use this key in **Host-only mode**, or in **Hybrid** mode with the pieces you choose to handle at the table. The Host's phone is the board, the tracker and the moderator. Players without a phone need **Host-only mode**.

## What Each Card Means

| Piece | Cards |
|---|---|
| Role cards | Hearts **7♥–Q♥** = **Loyalist** · clubs **J♣–K♣** = **Syndicate** · **K♠** = **the Boss** |
| Party cards | Diamonds **A♦–6♦** = Loyalist · clubs **A♣–4♣** = Syndicate (the Boss's party is Syndicate). Shown only for an Inquiry. |
| Policy pile | Hearts **A♥–6♥** = **Reform** (6) · spades **A♠–J♠** = **Decree** (11). 17 cards. |
| Placards | **Red joker** = the Speaker (passes left) · **Black joker** = the Chancellor nominee |
| Votes | Thumbs up = Aye, thumbs down = Nay, everyone on three. Or a red and a black card from a second deck for each player. |
| Unrest and board | Track it on the Host's phone, or with three coins. Lay enacted policies face up in two rows. |

## What to Pull for Each Table

| Players | Loyalists | Syndicate | Party cards | Powers on Decrees 1–5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **5** | **7♥–9♥** (3) | **J♣** (1) + **K♠** Boss | **A♦–3♦** Loyalist<br>**A♣–2♣** Syndicate | — · — · The docket · Execution · Execution |
| **6** | **7♥–10♥** (4) | **J♣** (1) + **K♠** Boss | **A♦–4♦** Loyalist<br>**A♣–2♣** Syndicate | — · — · The docket · Execution · Execution |
| **7** | **7♥–10♥** (4) | **J♣–Q♣** (2) + **K♠** Boss | **A♦–4♦** Loyalist<br>**A♣–3♣** Syndicate | — · Inquiry · Snap election · Execution · Execution |
| **8** | **7♥–J♥** (5) | **J♣–Q♣** (2) + **K♠** Boss | **A♦–5♦** Loyalist<br>**A♣–3♣** Syndicate | — · Inquiry · Snap election · Execution · Execution |
| **9** | **7♥–J♥** (5) | **J♣–K♣** (3) + **K♠** Boss | **A♦–5♦** Loyalist<br>**A♣–4♣** Syndicate | Inquiry · Inquiry · Snap election · Execution · Execution |
| **10** | **7♥–Q♥** (6) | **J♣–K♣** (3) + **K♠** Boss | **A♦–6♦** Loyalist<br>**A♣–4♣** Syndicate | Inquiry · Inquiry · Snap election · Execution · Execution |

Rebalanced tables (house rule): at 6 players put one Decree face up on the board before you start; at 7 remove the J♠ from the pile; at 9 remove the J♠ and 10♠.

## Setup

1. Pull the role cards for your table, shuffle them face down and deal one to each player. Look at your own card in secret.

2. Each player takes the party card that matches their role (a diamond for a heart, a club for a club or the K♠) and keeps it face down in front of them. Do this one by one, eyes closed if you like, or let the Host hand them out without looking.
3. Shuffle the 17 policy cards face down: this is the draw pile.
4. Choose the first Speaker at random (the app's coin or picker works) and give them the red joker.
5. Read the eyes-closed script, then play: the Speaker hands the black joker to a nominee, everyone votes on three, and an elected government draws three, the Speaker discards one face down, the Chancellor discards one face down and lays the last face up.

## Eyes-Closed Script (Read Aloud)

### 5 OR 6 PLAYERS

1. *Everyone, close your eyes and put your fist on the table.*
2. *Syndicate and the Boss, open your eyes and look around. These are your allies.*
3. *Boss, raise your thumb so the Syndicate know you. … Everyone, close your eyes. Thumbs down.*
4. *Everyone, open your eyes.*

### 7 TO 10 PLAYERS

1. *Everyone, close your eyes and put your fist on the table.*
2. *Syndicate, open your eyes. Boss, keep yours closed, and raise your thumb so the Syndicate know who you are.*
3. *… Syndicate, close your eyes. Boss, thumb down.*
4. *Everyone, open your eyes.*

The Gilded Chamber is an original game in the hidden-role policy family; names, wording and art are its own.